

UAE foils
illegal arms
deal linked
to Sudan

DUBAI
BY KHITAM ALAMIR
Chief News Editor

The UAE's Attorney-General Dr Hamad Saif Al Shamsi said yesterday that security services had foiled an attempt to illegally transfer weapons and military equipment to the Sudanese Armed Forces.

It followed the arrest of members of a cell involved in unauthorised mediation, brokering and illicit trafficking of military equipment, without obtaining the necessary licences from relevant authorities.

The defendants were arrested during an inspection of ammunition in a private aircraft at one of the country's airports. The plane was carrying approximately five million rounds of 7.54 x 62 mm Goryunov-type ammunition. Authorities also seized part of the financial proceeds from the deal in the possession of two suspects in their hotel rooms.

According to investigators, the cell members completed a military equipment deal involving Kalashnikov rifles, ammunition, machine guns, and grenades worth millions of dollars.

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Underground train planned
at Dubai's \$35b mega airport

DWC'S SUBWAY TRANSIT SYSTEM TO CUT TRAVEL DISTANCES AND TRANSFER TIMES

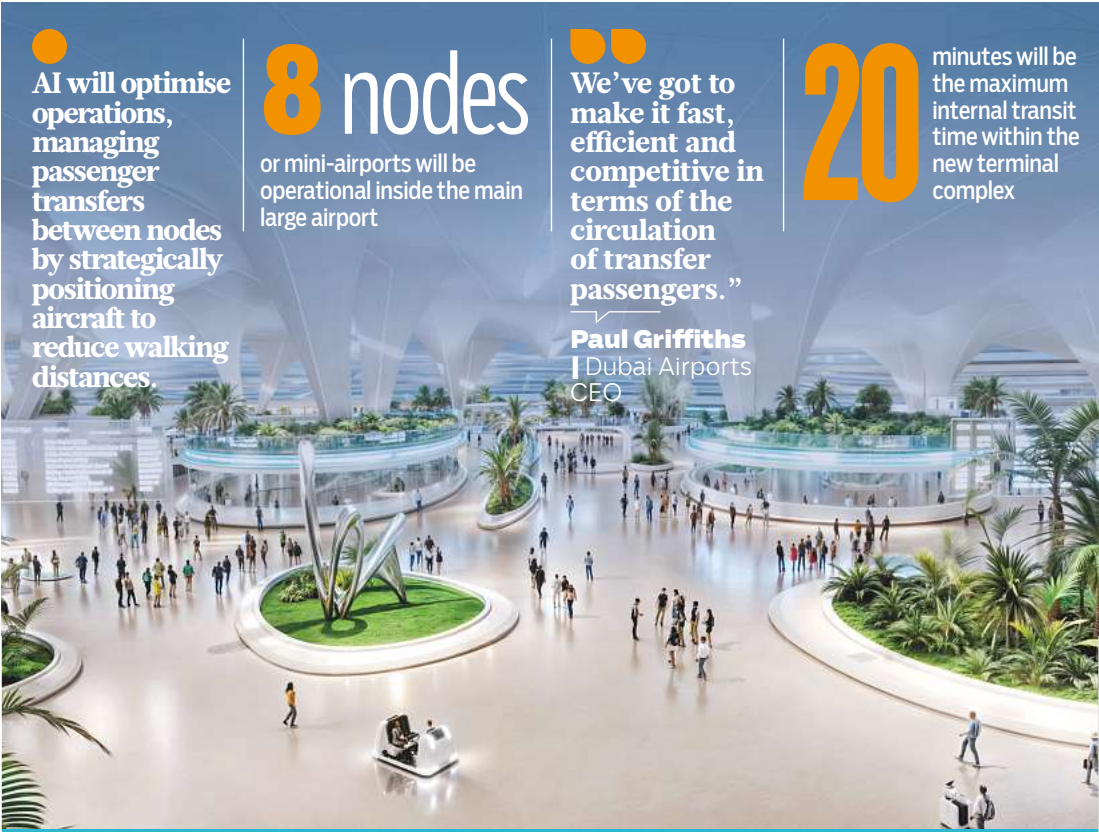
DUBAI
BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

Plans are underway to build a significant internal transportation system, including a comprehensive underground train network in the proposed \$35 billion Al Maktoum International Airport, or Dubai World Central (DWC), set to open by 2033.

The underground train system will help minimise travel distances and crucial transfer times for passengers connecting between flights, Dubai Airports CEO Paul Griffiths said on the sidelines of the Arabian Travel Market.

He said internal transit times within the new terminal complex could reach 15-20 minutes, comparable to journeys between major train stations in large cities like the trip from King's Cross to Paddington in London. According to Griffiths, internal trains are expected to include seating for passenger comfort.

SEE ALSO P5



DXB TRAFFIC SOARS TO 23.4M IN Q1; JANUARY SEES RECORD FLYERS

Dubai International (DXB) has started 2025 strongly, serving 23.4 million passengers in the first three months of the year, according to data released by Dubai Airports, the operator of Dubai's two airports – DXB and Al Maktoum International (DWC).

The Q1 figure represents a 1.5 per cent increase compared to the same period in 2024, building on the momentum of a record-breaking first quarter last year. January 2025 saw the highest monthly traffic ever recorded at DXB, welcoming 8.5 million passengers.

— D. G.

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WORKSHOPS



Mecha Lab 01 MAY
Sandro Cleuzo
Character Design Essentials:
From Concept to Final
Illustration - Workshop
6:00 PM - 7:30 PM



Creative Dojo 01 MAY
Sara Matta
The Principles of Animation:
Master Smooth & Expressive
Motion - Workshop
6:00 PM - 7:30 PM



Mecha Lab 02 MAY
Nobuyoshi Habara
Moderated by Yasmeen
Designing Iconic Mecha Anime: A Workshop
with the Creator of Gekiganger - WORKSHOP
2:15 PM - 3:45 PM





Mecha Lab 03 MAY
Sailor Moon & Yu-Gi-Oh!:
Moderated by Yasmeen
The Emotional Journey of
Creating Two Anime Icons -
Hiromi Matsushita & Kazuko
Tadano - TALK
4:30 - 5:30



03 MAY
Oto STAGE
EVENING EVENT
In the Heart of Anime - A
Tribute Concert to Studio Ghibli
Florence Pops Orchestra
9:00 PM



Otaku Stage 04 MAY
Tom and Tony Bancroft
Moderated by Valentina Martelli
Disney's Golden Age: Creating Animation That
Lives for Generations - PANEL
2:00 PM - 3:00 PM







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